Skillsforgez Business Plan

Version: 1.0
Prepared: 29 October 2026
Planning horizon: FY2027 to FY2029
Status: Working plan. Commercial assumptions require validation before fundraising or commitments.

1. Executive summary

Skillsforgez is an AI-powered career intelligence platform that converts evidence from a person's real work, including projects, work samples, guided reflections and practice scenarios, into a living skills profile, career-direction recommendations and practical growth sprints. It addresses a core problem in career development: CVs record titles and conventional assessments capture self-perception, while neither reliably shows demonstrated capability or the most useful next step.

The product will launch with a freemium individual experience and a paid **Momentum** plan at **US$12/month**, then expand through a higher-value **Teams** offer for organisations that need a shared view of capability and development. The initial focus is career changers and ambitious professionals; teams are the scale channel once the product proves that its analysis produces trusted, useful recommendations.

Our goal is to become the evidence layer for career growth: a private, explainable record of what people can do, what they are building and where they can thrive. Over the next 18 months, the business will validate recommendation quality, paid conversion, retention and its first repeatable team-sales motion.

Funding objective (planning assumption): raise **US$250,000** in pre-seed capital to fund an 18-month validation runway. The capital would support product and AI engineering, privacy/security foundations, customer discovery and disciplined go-to-market experiments. This is an operating hypothesis, not a valuation or offer.

2. Company and mission

Mission: Help people discover the work they are built for and make visible progress toward it.

Vision: A labour market where opportunity is based more on demonstrated, evolving capability than on job titles, credentials or self-description.

Business: Skillsforgez is a software platform for individual professionals and people-focused teams. Its core loop is: **bring real work, reveal the skill pattern, choose a direction, forge the next skill, and return with new evidence.**

The company will operate as a privacy-first software business in **Nigeria**. Its final registered entity name and entity type should be confirmed in the incorporation records before external financing, data processing at scale or contracting with teams.

Governance and ownership

The founding group holds **100 percent** of the business. There is no unallocated ownership at this stage. A founder-by-founder ownership schedule should be documented in the shareholder agreement before fundraising, together with any future employee option pool, adviser allocation or investor dilution. The business will have a five-member board consisting initially of the five named management-team members below. Board chair, voting rights, meeting cadence and independent-director arrangements remain to be formalised in the shareholder and board agreements.

3. Problem, customer and solution

Problem

Individuals commonly face three connected frictions:

1. They cannot translate everyday work into a credible view of their strengths or transferable skills.
2. They receive generic career and learning advice that does not fit their goal, time or evidence of capability.
3. They struggle to show growth in interviews, performance discussions and career changes.

Teams experience the same issue at an organisational level: talent conversations often rely on titles, manager opinion and incomplete self-assessment, making capability gaps and internal mobility hard to see.

Solution

Skillsforgez analyses user-provided work evidence to identify capabilities such as reasoning, communication, execution and collaboration. It provides:

Product element	Customer outcome
Work-signal analysis	Turns projects, tasks and reflections into skill evidence.
Living skills profile	Shows demonstrated strengths, emerging capabilities and development edges.
Career-direction engine	Explains role and environment fit using current capability.
Personalised growth sprints	Converts insight into short, practical actions and reflection.
Progress narrative	Gives users a clear account of what they practised and can now do.
Team skill landscape (Teams)	Gives managers a shared, consent-based view of capability and pathways.

Initial ideal customer profiles

Primary B2C: Nigerian professionals and aspiring professionals aged **18 to 40** in the information-technology sector. They have meaningful work examples but lack confidence or clarity about their next move. They are motivated by a job change, promotion, performance review or deliberate upskilling.

Primary B2B: Nigerian people and learning leaders in small and mid-sized IT and knowledge-work teams of 50 to 500 employees, with a visible need for internal mobility, capability development or more useful manager-development conversations.

Launch geography

Nigeria is the initial launch country. The early product and marketing experience should be designed for Nigerian IT professionals and employers, including locally relevant career pathways, pricing/payment preferences and trusted community channels. International expansion should follow only after the Nigerian launch demonstrates retention and a repeatable acquisition motion.

4. Market opportunity and positioning

Skillsforgez operates at the intersection of career coaching, skills assessment, learning and talent intelligence. Its entry market is not "everyone seeking work"; it is users with enough work evidence to benefit from an evidence-led profile and a near-term decision to make.

Positioning

> **Skillsforgez helps people turn real work into an explainable skills story and a practical next move.**

The differentiation is not a generic AI chat experience or a one-time personality test. It is the evidence-to-action loop: users bring work, receive a transparent interpretation, act on a focused sprint and return with new proof.

Competitive alternatives

Alternative	Strength	Skillsforgez response
CV builders and job boards	Discovery and application workflow	Focus on capability discovery before the application.
Personality/skills assessments	Simple benchmark and language	Use real work evidence and update the profile over time.
Career coaches	Human empathy and accountability	Offer accessible, always-on guidance; partner with coaches where human support is needed.
Learning platforms	Broad content libraries	Start with a specific capability goal and recommend action, not a catalogue.
Talent-management suites	Enterprise workflow and data integrations	Begin with a lighter, employee-centred product and prove utility in small teams.

Market-sizing method to validate

Do not present an unsupported top-down TAM as traction. Instead, calculate opportunity from reachable segments:

- **B2C serviceable market:** qualified audience reached through content, partnerships and communities multiplied by free-profile activation, paid conversion and annual recurring revenue per paid user (US$144 at current price).

- **B2B serviceable market:** target organisations in the first geography or vertical multiplied by qualified sales conversations, pilot win rate and annual contract value.

The first 90 days should establish the numbers from real acquisition channels, interviews and pilots. The plan deliberately avoids claiming a market-size figure until that work is complete. Its first market-sizing exercise should calculate the number of reachable Nigerian IT professionals aged 18 to 40 and the number of target Nigerian IT employers, then apply observed conversion and contract rates.

5. Business model

Revenue model

Plan	Published offer	Revenue logic
Explorer	Free foundational profile, one guided reflection and three tailored next steps	Acquisition, activation and trust-building.
Momentum	US$12/month; unlimited reflections, personalised sprints and progress trends	Recurring B2C subscription revenue.
Teams	Skill landscape, shared pathways, manager insight dashboard and onboarding	Annual B2B subscription priced by team size and support needs.

Pricing actions: retain the US$12/month test price for the first cohort; test annual billing and a higher-value tier only after observing activation and retention. For Teams, price pilots explicitly, then convert successful pilots to annual contracts. Avoid custom feature work that does not strengthen the common product.

Unit-economics targets (to validate)

Metric	Initial operating target	Why it matters
Profile completion after sign-up	At least 60 percent	Measures whether first value is clear.
Free-to-paid conversion	At least 5 percent by month 6	Tests willingness to pay.
Month-3 paid retention	At least 70 percent	Tests ongoing product value.
B2C customer-acquisition cost	No more than US$35 blended	Supports a payback period under three months at US$12/month before gross margin.
B2B pilot-to-annual conversion	At least 40 percent	Validates the team proposition.
Gross margin	At least 80 percent	Requires disciplined AI/inference and support costs.

6. Go-to-market plan

Stage 1: prove individual value (months 0 to 6)

Recruit a design-partner cohort of 75 to 150 individuals through career-change communities, professional groups, alumni networks and founder-led outreach. Offer concierge onboarding in exchange for structured feedback. The conversion event is not merely sign-up; it is completing a profile, understanding one recommendation and taking one action.

Content should demonstrate the product's point of view: how to convert a project into skills evidence, prepare a development conversation, or identify transferable strengths. Use case studies only with permission and clearly distinguish real outcomes from illustrative demos.

Stage 2: establish a repeatable B2C channel (months 6 to 12)

Double down on channels with measurable activated-user cost: search/content, trusted community partners, coach/referral partners and webinars. Build email lifecycle prompts around the next growth sprint and new work evidence. Paid acquisition begins only after retention supports it.

Stage 3: sell accountable team pilots (months 9 to 18)

Approach 20 to 30 people and learning leaders in a narrow vertical. Sell 8 to 12 week pilots with a mutually agreed outcome: employee activation, manager-usefulness score, skill evidence added, internal-mobility conversation quality or development-plan completion. Convert the strongest pilots into annual subscriptions and publish anonymised proof points.

Sales funnel

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Audience, then skills-profile sign-up, then completed first reflection, then recommendation understood, then paid Momentum or team pilot, then retained subscriber or annual team contract
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7. Product, technology and operations

Product roadmap

Period	Deliverables	Decision gate
Months 0 to 3	Reliable intake, profile explanation, feedback capture, consent controls	Do users understand and trust the analysis?
Months 4 to 6	Growth-sprint workflow, progress narrative, subscription billing, analytics	Are users returning and converting?
Months 7 to 12	Improved recommendation quality, coach and partner workflow, pilot-ready team controls	Can a team pilot deliver a measurable result?
Months 13 to 18	Team dashboard, administration and security maturity, annual-contract workflow	Is the B2B motion repeatable and retention-positive?

Responsible AI and data commitments

The business handles career-relevant information and may influence consequential user choices. It must therefore:

- analyse only material the user has the right to share and make the user the source of consent;
- explain recommendations as evidence and confidence, not as definitive judgments;
- provide correction, deletion, export and opt-out paths;
- minimise stored personal data, separate identity from analysis where practical, and set retention limits;
- test for uneven performance across relevant groups and prohibit discriminatory employer use;
- use human review and escalation for high-impact team use cases; and
- maintain a documented model, data and vendor-risk review before enterprise sales.

These safeguards are product requirements, not a later compliance project.

Operating model and key hires

Management team

The company is led by the following initial management team. The short biographies state operational responsibilities; they should be expanded with verified education, work history, relevant achievements and references before investor due diligence.

Person	Title	Description
Oladele Olalere	Chief Executive Officer	Leads company strategy, customer and partner relationships, fundraising and commercial execution. Responsible for keeping the product aligned with the needs of Nigerian IT professionals and employers.
Oladele Faith	Chief Technology Officer	Leads product technology, AI implementation, platform reliability and data-security decisions. Responsible for translating the Skillsforgez product vision into a scalable, trusted user experience.
Oladele Olutoyin	Chief Financial Officer	Leads financial planning, budgeting, cash management, reporting and commercial controls. Responsible for monitoring the revenue-led operating model and funding runway.
Oladele Peace	Executive Manager	Coordinates day-to-day execution across product, operations and customer experience. Responsible for turning company priorities into accountable delivery plans.
Oladele Adesola	Manager	Supports team operations, customer engagement and the implementation of business priorities. Responsible for maintaining organised processes as the company grows.

The five management-team members form the initial five-member board, subject to legal incorporation and formal appointment.

The minimum operating roles are:

Role	Responsibility	Timing
CEO / commercial lead	Customer discovery, partnerships, fundraising, sales	Existing founder role
Product/AI lead	Product quality, evaluation, data architecture and AI cost control	Existing founder or first technical hire
Product engineer	Reliable product delivery, analytics, integrations	Months 0 to 3
Growth/customer researcher	Cohort recruitment, lifecycle, interviews and insight synthesis	Contract or part-time in months 0 to 6
Privacy/security adviser	Policy, vendor review and B2B readiness	Fractional before team pilots

8. Milestones and measures

Milestone	Target date	Success evidence
Design-partner cohort live	Month 2	75 users recruited and consented to feedback.
Insight-quality benchmark	Month 3	At least 70 percent of active testers rate the profile as useful and understandable.
Paid-value test	Month 6	At least 5 percent free-to-paid conversion and at least 60 percent profile completion.
Retention proof	Month 9	At least 70 percent paid month-3 retention; documented churn reasons.
First team pilots	Month 12	3 paid or tightly scoped pilots with pre-agreed outcomes.
Repeatability decision	Month 18	At least 2 annual team conversions or evidence to narrow/revise the Teams offer.

9. Financial plan

The following is a directional, annual operating model in US dollars, built from the published US$12/month Momentum price and explicit team-contract assumptions. It is a budgeting tool, not a forecast or statement of current performance. Skillsforgez is pursuing a revenue-driven model, but it has not yet reported revenue, a waitlist or quantified paid traction.

Current validation status

Current market learning is based on news and podcast research, human conversations and observed high engagement with the concept. The business reports few direct competitors in its initial niche. These are early qualitative signals, not statistically validated market evidence. There is currently **no waitlist**, and the plan does not claim existing revenue or quantified engagement metrics. Before relying on the financial model, the team should record the number of interviews, activation rate, paid conversion, retention, acquisition cost, revenue and direct competitors using a consistent monthly dashboard.

Revenue assumptions

Assumption	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029
Average paid Momentum subscribers	400	1,500	4,000
Momentum subscription revenue	$57,600	$216,000	$576,000
Annual team contracts	8	30	75
Average annual contract value	$5,000	$9,000	$15,000
Teams revenue	$40,000	$270,000	$1,125,000
Total revenue	**$97,600**	**$486,000**	**$1,701,000**

Directional operating model

US$	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029
Total revenue	$97,600	$486,000	$1,701,000
Cost of revenue (AI, infrastructure, payment/support)	$19,500	$87,500	$300,000
Gross profit	**$78,100**	**$398,500**	**$1,401,000**
Product and engineering	$120,000	$190,000	$365,000
Sales and marketing	$45,000	$110,000	$280,000
General, privacy and administration	$55,000	$90,000	$175,000
Operating result	**($141,900)**	**$8,500**	**$581,000**

The model implies a cash need beyond the FY2027 operating loss because working capital, contingencies and months before revenue collection matter. The US$250,000 planning raise should be released against milestones, with a monthly cash forecast maintained from launch. If retention or B2B conversion miss targets, reduce spend and extend runway rather than assuming growth will repair the gap.

10. Risks, context and responses

Risk/context change	Early signal	Response
Users do not trust AI interpretation	Low profile completion; negative qualitative feedback	Show source evidence, uncertainty and edit/correct mechanisms; use human-reviewed evaluation.
Weak retention	Paid users stop after first insight	Improve sprint accountability and recurring value before increasing acquisition spend.
AI costs grow faster than revenue	Cost per active user rises	Measure cost by workflow, set limits, cache/reuse safely and redesign expensive flows.
Privacy or employment-law exposure	Teams request opaque scoring or employee surveillance	Refuse prohibited uses; maintain consent, data-minimisation and legal review.
Large platforms copy surface features	Prospects see it as a feature	Defend with trusted workflow, evidence quality, user relationships and vertical proof.
B2B sales cycles are slow	Pilots stall or require excessive tailoring	Keep B2C learning engine active, sell narrow pilots and productise common needs.
Founder/key-person dependency	Decisions or sales stop when one person is unavailable	Document operating processes, add advisers and hire complementary capability.

11. Risk and reward scenarios

In the Sahlman framework, the plan should show how the venture adapts rather than pretend the future is certain.

Scenario	Conditions	Action
Downside	Conversion <3%, month-3 retention <50%, no paid team pilot by month 12	Pause paid acquisition, narrow to the best-performing individual use case, reduce burn and re-test willingness to pay.
Base case	Targets in Section 8 achieved; early team pilots convert	Continue B2C growth and productise the team workflow.
Upside	Strong referral growth, retention at least 80 percent and rapid pilot conversion	Add sales capacity carefully, prioritise security and customer success before broad enterprise expansion.

12. Immediate next steps

1. Apply the **Skillsforgez** name consistently across all product surfaces, legal documents and customer communications.
2. Add founder/team biographies, entity details, target launch geography and ownership structure.
3. Conduct 30 to 40 structured customer interviews and recruit the first design-partner cohort.
4. Define the skills taxonomy, evaluation rubric and user-facing explanation standard before scaling AI analysis.
5. Instrument activation, recommendation usefulness, conversion, retention, AI cost and referral from the first release.
6. Build the cash forecast and replace all illustrative financial assumptions with observed results monthly.
7. Prepare privacy notices, terms, data-processing workflows and a clear policy for team/employer use before collecting sensitive work evidence.

13. Planning framework and sources

This plan follows the conventional startup-plan sequence of executive summary, problem and solution, market, product, marketing, operations, financials and appendix, while applying William A. Sahlman's four investor questions: **people, opportunity, context, and risk and reward**. The factual product and pricing inputs are drawn from the supplied Skillsforgez website files. The financials, milestones, hiring, funding and market assumptions are newly created planning assumptions, not claims of existing performance.

Sahlman's central point is that a plan should be a road map for adapting to uncertainty, not a falsely precise prediction. See Harvard Business School's summary of the framework: How to Write a Great Business Plan.